



Department of English

Course Code: ENG102

1. Write down a response paper (of 220-250 words) on the following text.

Ragging turns into a weapon of torture in universities

Staff Reporter, Dhaka

Ragging, once used both in the eastern and western universities to orient fresh students about campus culture, has now turned into a weapon of torture, both mental and physical. After the murder of the Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology (BUET) student Abrar Fahad, images of torture on general students are coming out.

This is a common scenario in all dormitories of the most of the public university. Generally, the university authorities accommodate freshers in the "Gono Room" of dormitories where over 100 new students stay for at least six months.

Political leaders use their supporters among the second-year students to have control over the freshers. They go to the "Gono Room" every midnight and carry out brutal oppression on freshers in the name of ragging and teaching them manners. Such oppression is part of the ragging culture in every JU dorm nowadays.

Although the university authorities have taken the initiative to end ragging and oppression in departments in the last few years, they have failed to stop such activities. Every year, when freshers come to the university, ragging becomes the burning issue on the campus. But it is buried after several weeks as the university authorities show reluctance.

Many fresh students are injured seriously after such assault and harassment by seniors. Last year, Azwad Rahman of the environmental sciences department became sick in Shahed Rafiq Jabbar Hall as seniors physically assaulted him in the name of ragging. The same year, Mizanur Rahman of the computer sciences department became psychologically imbalanced due to torture in the name of ragging.

So, every year many students face lot of sufferings in the name of ragging in dormitories. Although the hall authorities are informed about the incidents, not much is done to end such activities. President of the Provost Committee, Prof. Bashir Ahmed, said: "I have been informed about the incidents. We have made enough attempts to end such activities on the campus this year. The university authorities have taken the initiative to raise awareness against such misdeeds."

Describing these practices as “mental harassment”, another student of Sir Salimullah Muslim Hall said: “They treat us like dirt. We can do nothing to change this situation. They always shout and use abusive language even over trifling matters. In guest rooms, you always have to stand still and straight. It seems a court martial is going on.”

In the guest rooms, leaders do nothing but “teach” the newcomers about a set of “manners”, including dealing with political leaders, delivering political speeches and chanting slogans in rallies and processions.

Owing to such activities, many freshers do not want to stay in dorms. This correspondent spoke to some freshers who are not staying in dormitories. They informed that first-year students are not able to do well in the final exams as they cannot take part in regular classes due to the extortion of their seniors in the name of “ragging”. As a result, many of them drop out.

Source: The Independent